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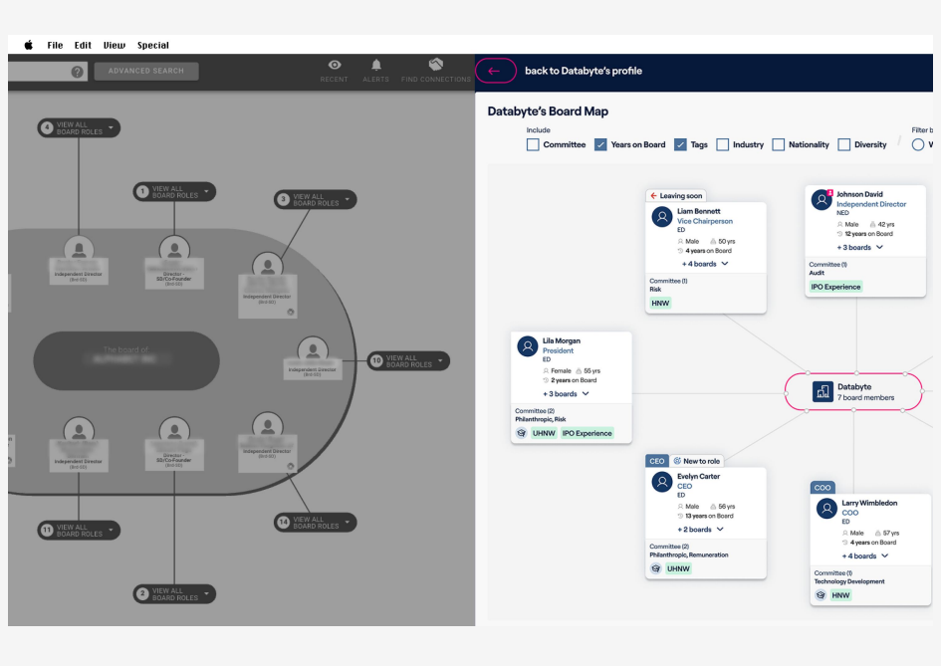
Old to New

Design decisions made while consolidating four legacy brands into one platform.

Background: Altrata brought four legacy brands into one platform. Each had its own users, its own conventions, and features people had spent years learning the hard way.

Problem: Redesigning meant handling change-averse clients with high-stakes workflows, who needed the new platform to do everything the old one did, and better.
My approach was to ask why each decision was made in the first place, since the original reasoning usually explains the problem, then rebuild the workflow end to end rather than patch the symptom.



Users
Senior analysts, prospect researchers, CRM managers, and risk officers across wealth and professional services

Company
Altrata, London
(shipped & ongoing)

Team
UX Designer (me)
UI/UX Director
Product Owners
Developers

What I did
User Research
Design Audit
Conceptualisation
User testing
Dev handoff

Duration
Over 3 years

What you'll see below

Three redesigns from the consolidation. Each shipped, each tested with clients, each replacing something people had used for years.

THEN	NOW
The legacy feature, and what broke	What shipped, and what it changed
Problems from design audit, client feedback sessions	The decision behind each change
	Outcome: UAT, release, client response

Board-to-Board Connections

(one of the most loved feature from legacy brands)

A view showing every board role a person holds at once, so you can see **where one board connects to another.**

A **conversation starter in sales pitches** to financial services and executive search clients. Connections between board roles, due diligence, and more. Several hundred accounts use it.

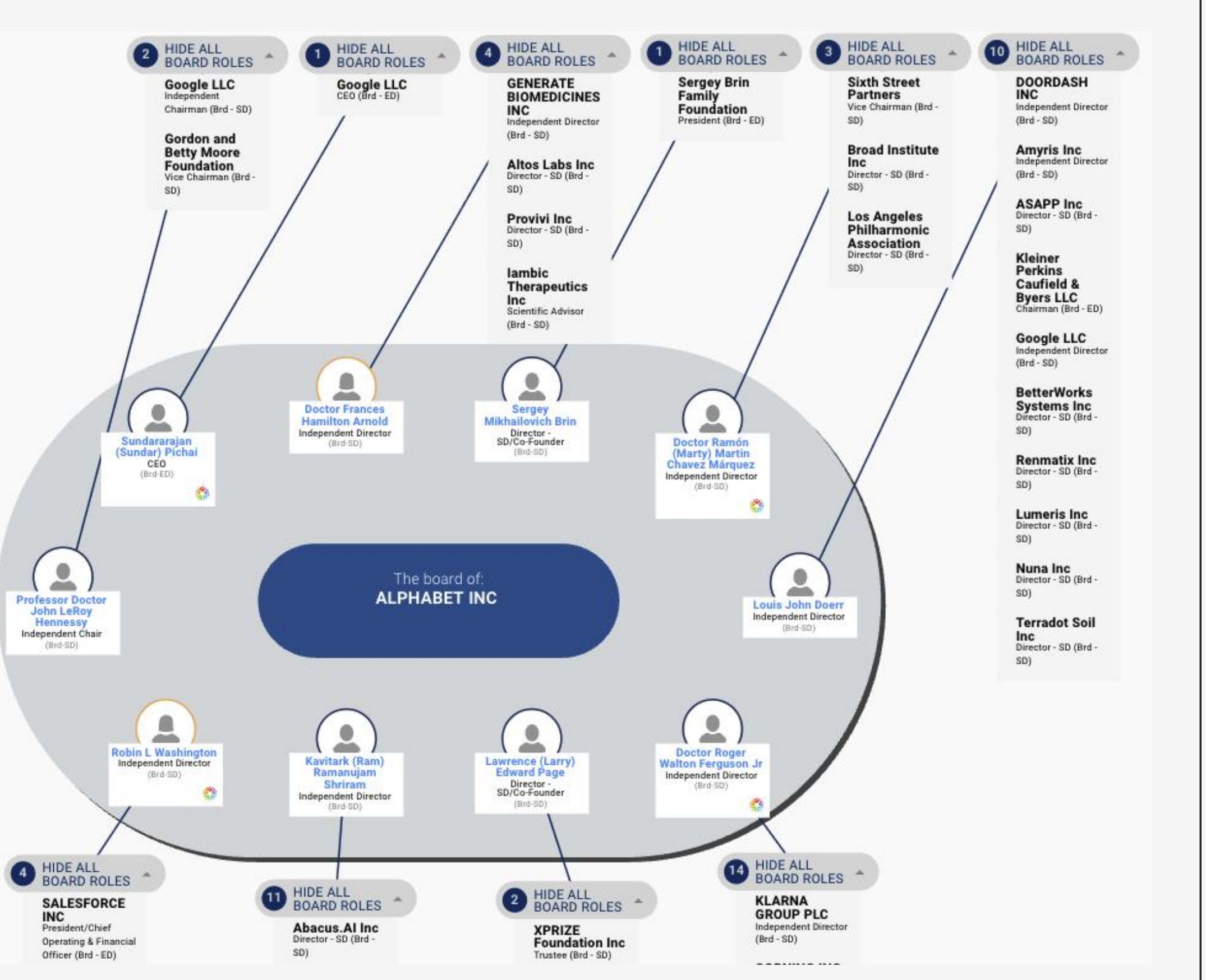
Then

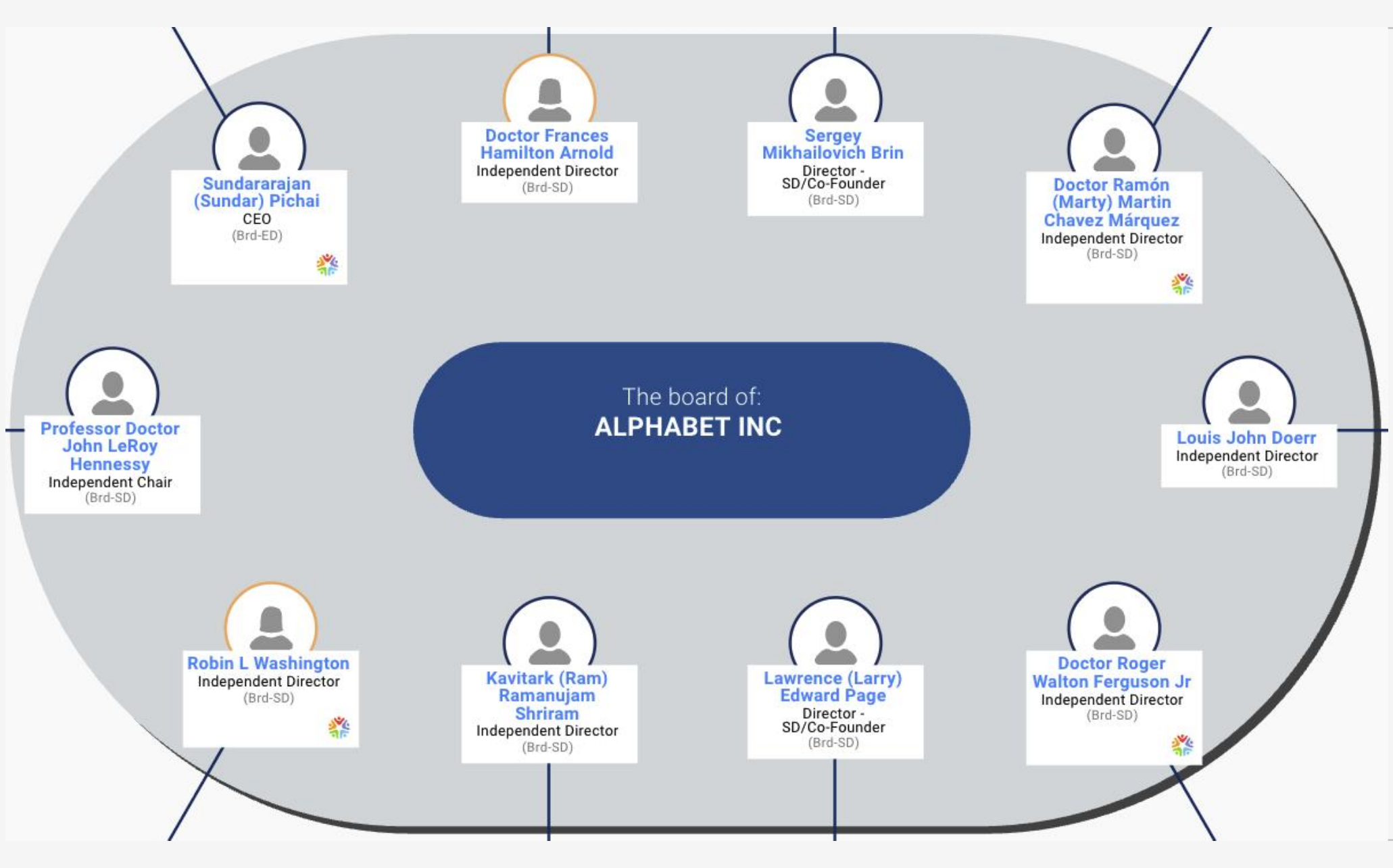
How BoardEx handled it

Users were aligning cards by hand

In sessions, most users dragged cards side by side to compare companies and roles across board members. The product had no comparison view, so they built one manually, every time.

Captured from client feedback calls and stakeholders review.





No way to tell roles apart at a glance

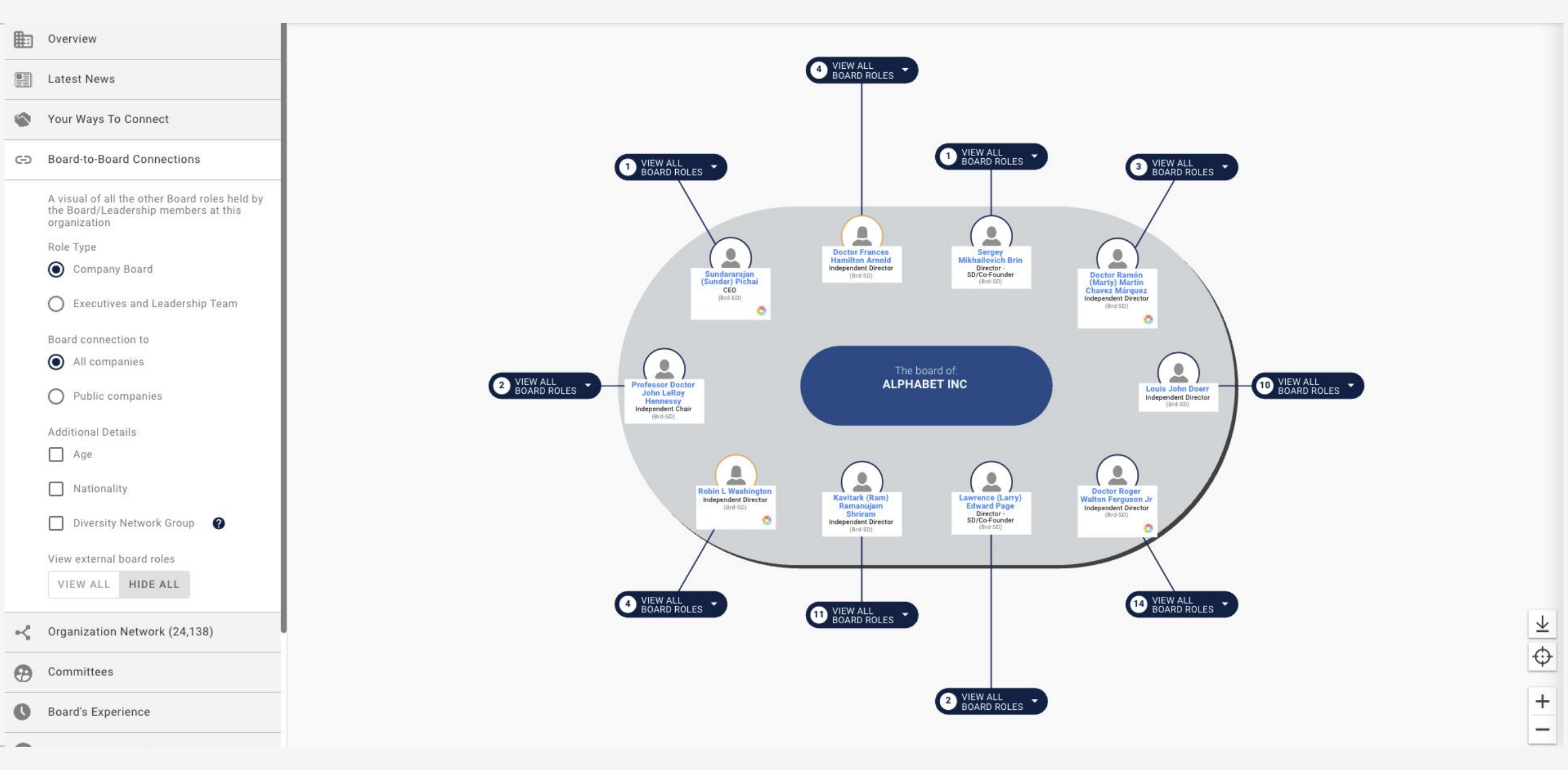
Gender was marked by colour and icon with no legend to explain it. Executive and non-executive roles looked identical. Age, tenure and committee membership, all of which matter to a researcher weren't shown at all.

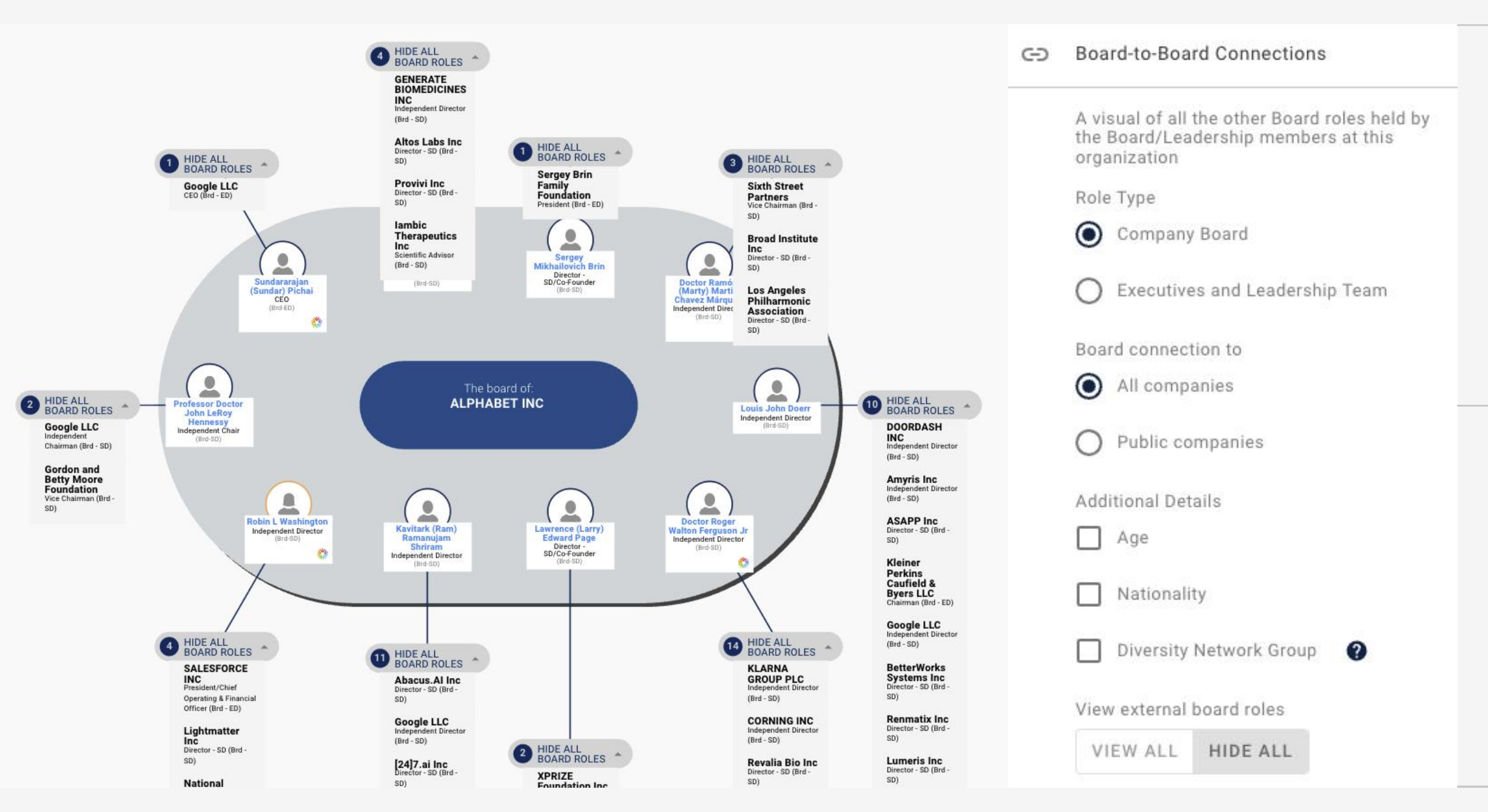
Captured from client feedback calls, internal stakeholders feedback and design audit.

The name of the company was louder than the people

Cards carried the names and roles that users actually came for, but the central company node dominated the layout.

Captured from design audit.





Filters sat in a side panel and barely used the data

A narrow set of options, while the database held far more that researchers would have used.

Captured from client feedback calls, internal stakeholders feedback and design audit.

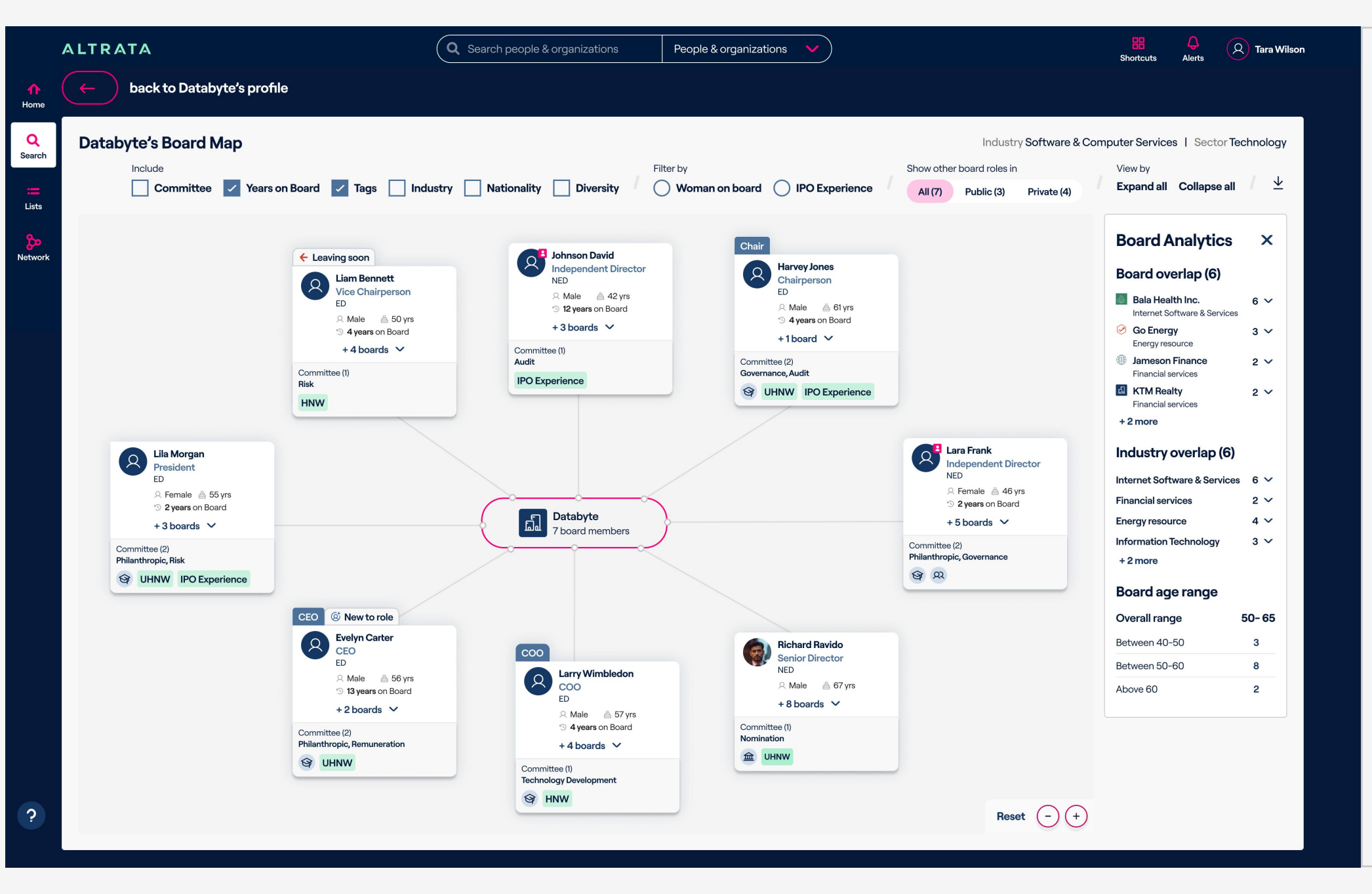
Expand all overlapped

Opening every board role expanded them in place, where they overlapped each other. The feature intended to reveal more made less readable.

Captured from design audit and observing clients in live call.

NOW

Board Map
Named by internal vote, against a long list of alternatives. It's what the view actually does: makes connections visible.



Cards first, company second

The emphasis moved to the cards and the names on them. The company node became context rather than the headline.

The decision: shrinking the central node was the obvious fix. I inverted the hierarchy instead, so the layout is built around people, which is how users describe the view themselves.

Supporting data on the cards

Name, role, tenure and committee data now sit on the card, so researchers have what they need without opening anything.

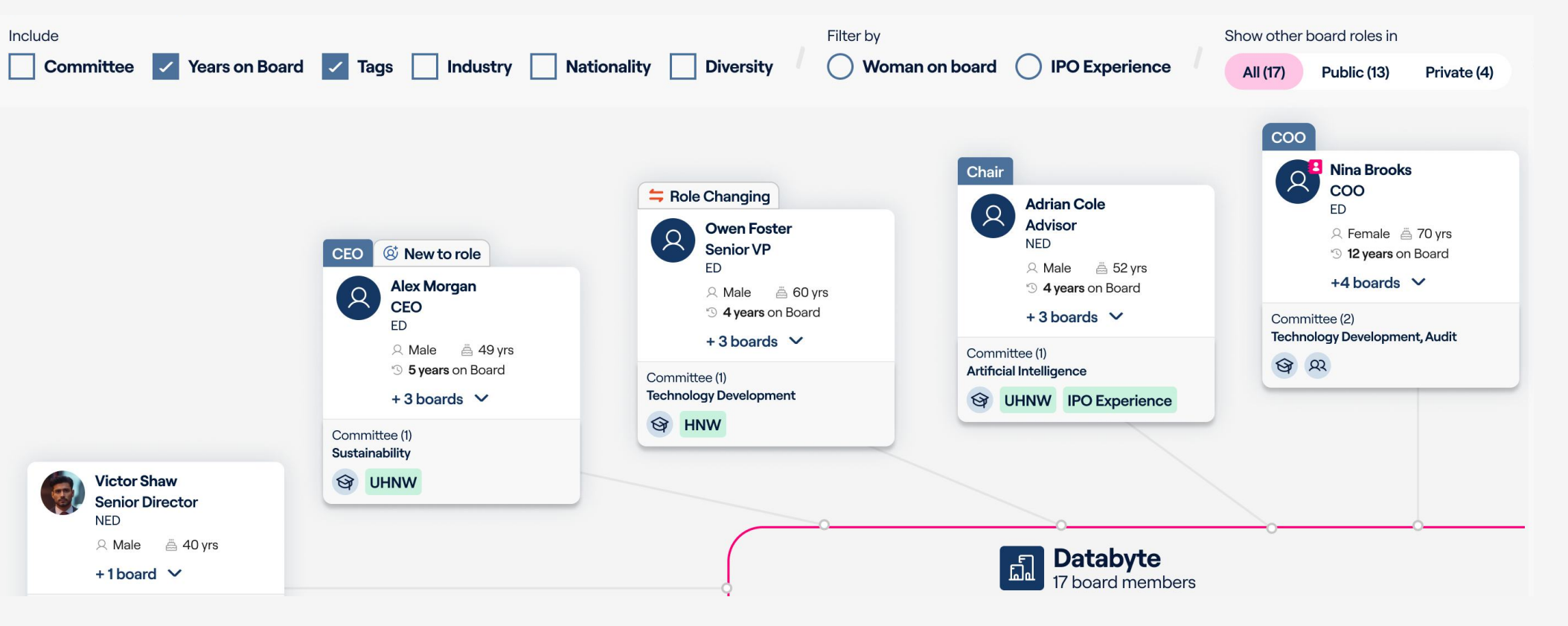
The decision: name, age, nationality and role match profiles elsewhere in the platform. Tenure and committee data came from client calls and product managers.

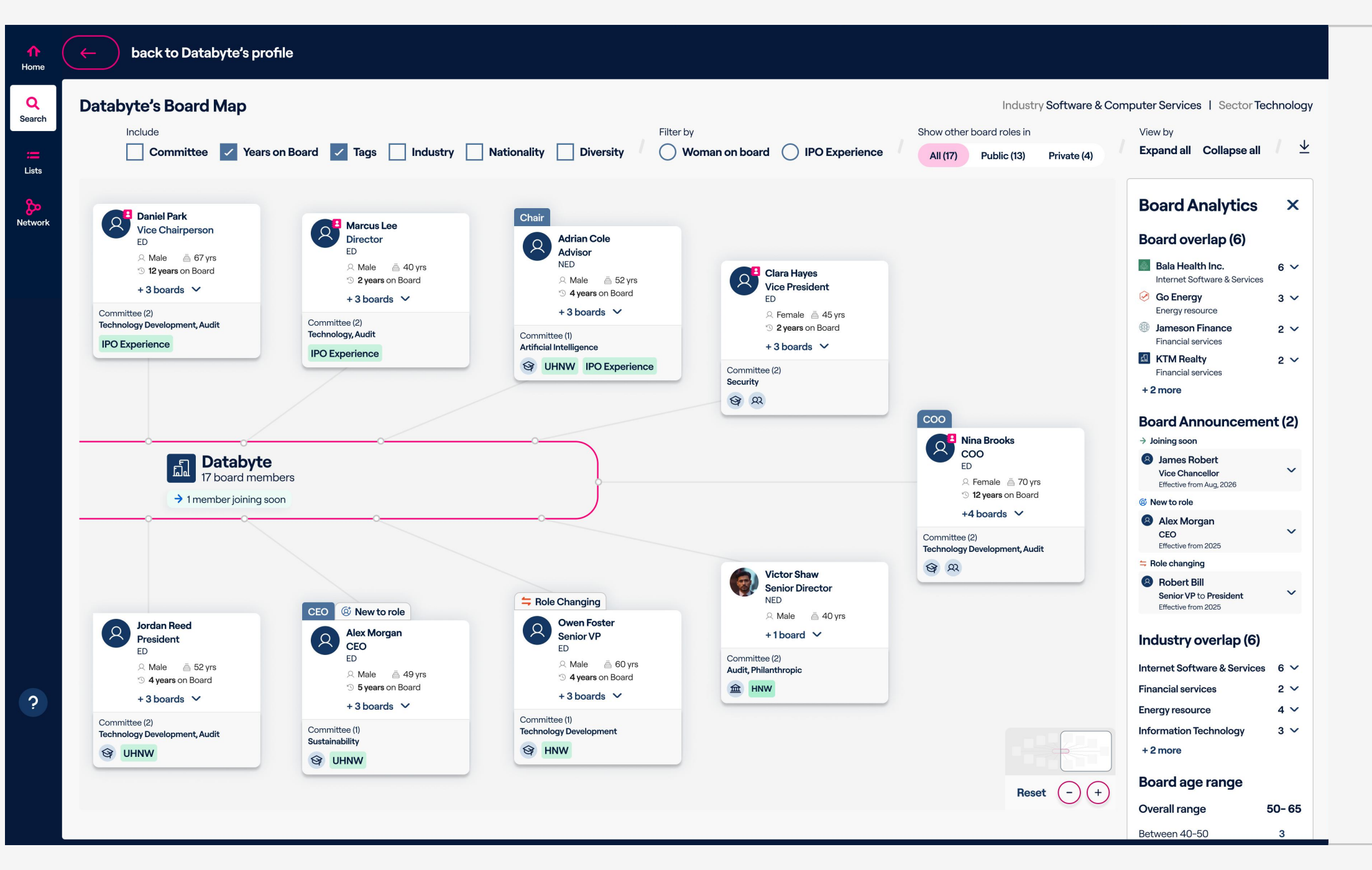
Badges for executive roles

Executive roles carry a badge. The old view treated everyone the same, so separating them meant filtering manually.

Filters at the forefront

Every essential filter and inclusion moved into the header, out of the side panel.





Zoom set for large boards

Large boards open zoomed in, with a legend at the bottom showing where you are on the page.

The decision: users got lost on the open canvas with nothing to orient against. Scroll or pagination would have fixed that but broken the connected view. The new design keeps the movement and adds orientation.

Status badges for movement

Cards now show if someone is new to a role or leaving soon, drawn from role status data we already held.

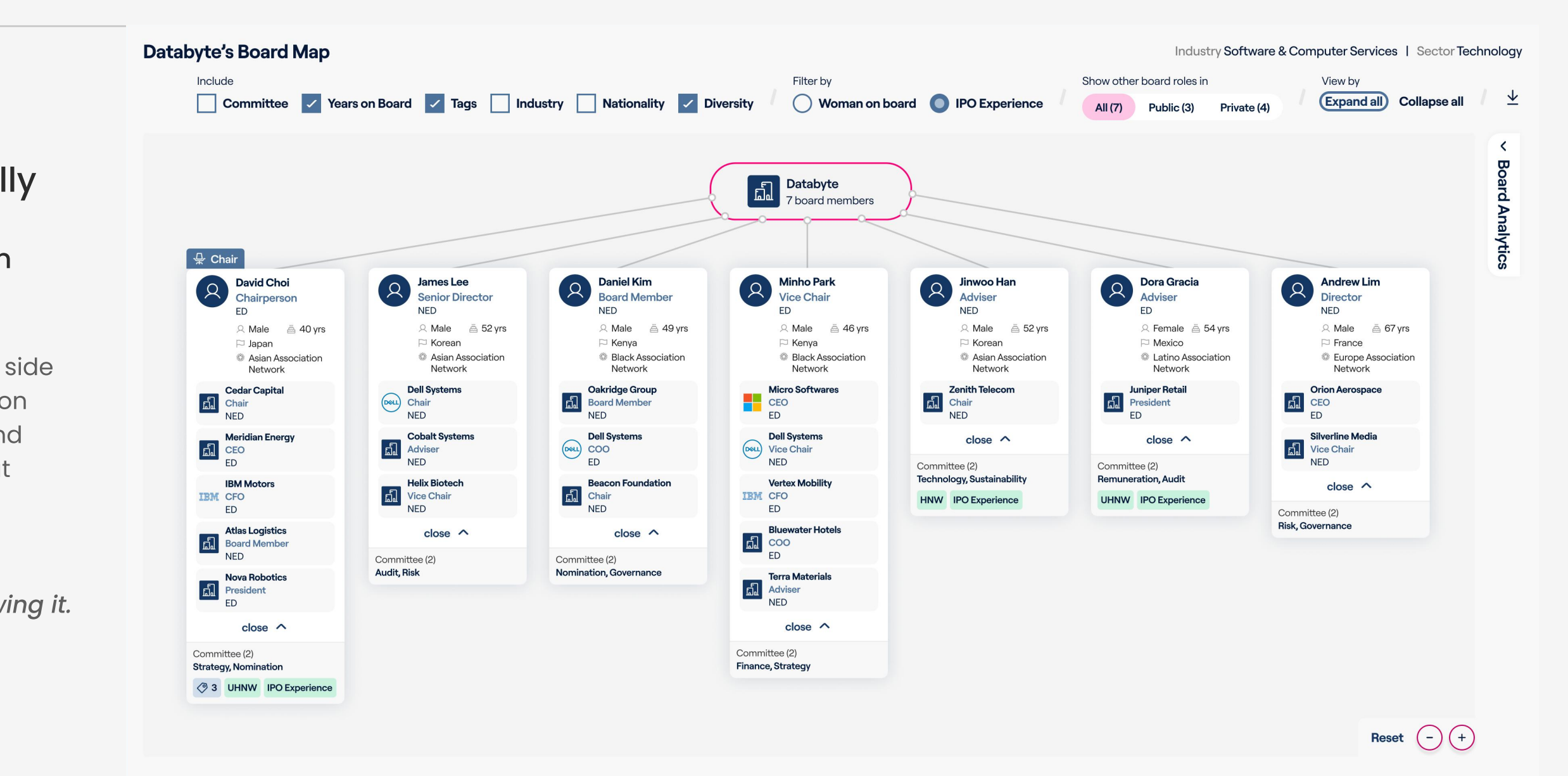
The decision: this wasn't requested. We had the data and nobody was using it, so I surfaced it where the decision gets made.

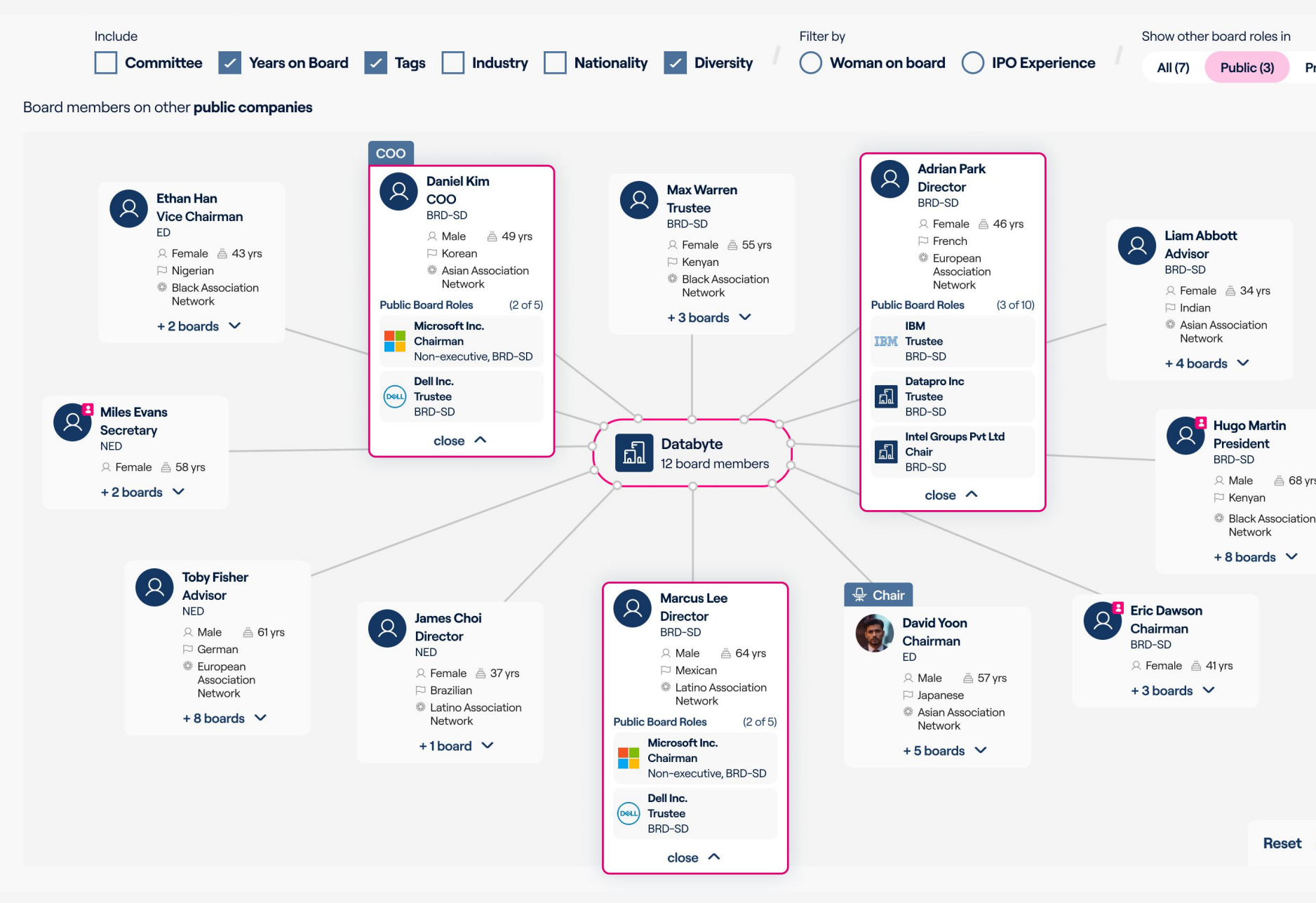
Expand all now aligns automatically

Expanding opens cards aligned rather than overlapping.

The decision: users were already dragging cards side by side to compare. Rather than add a comparison mode they'd have to learn, I changed what expand already did. The workaround disappeared without anyone having to adopt anything.

Where this goes next: the comparison runs automatically using AI rather than the user drawing it. That work is with the data and design teams.





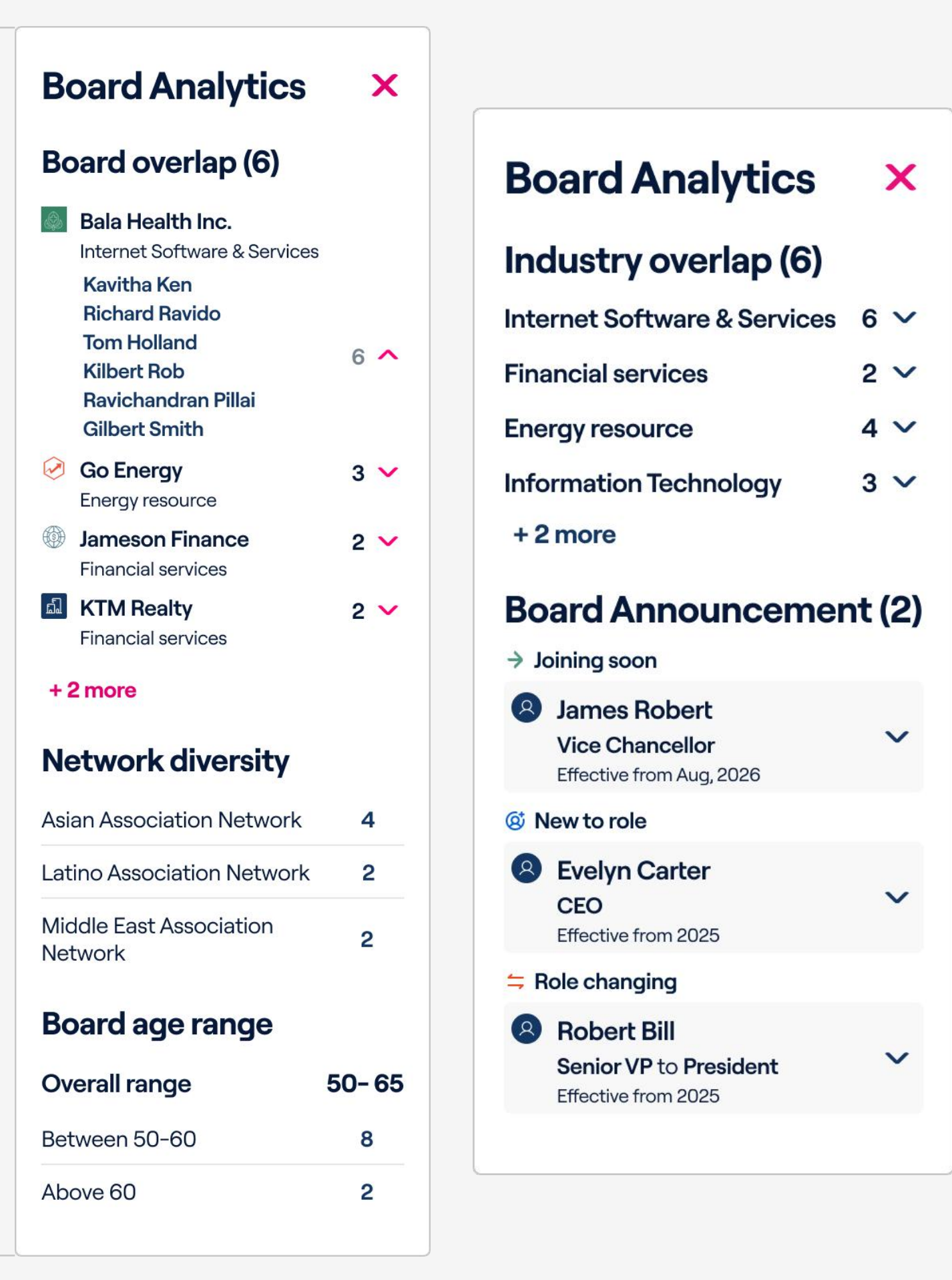
Highlighting on filter

Filtering by public or private roles expands and highlights the matching cards rather than hiding the rest, so the result stays in context.

Board analytics

Industry overlap, board announcements, network diversity and board age range, surfaced as data rather than left for the user to work out.

The decision: this is the analysis users were doing in their heads from this view. We could draw it from data we already had, so I proposed we show it. Nobody asked for it.



Board Analytics

Board overlap (6)

Bala Health Inc.
Internet Software & Services
Kavitha Ken
Richard Ravido
Tom Holland
Kilbert Rob
Ravichandran Pillai
Gilbert Smith
6

Go Energy
Energy resource
3

Jameson Finance
Financial services
2

KTM Realty
Financial services
2

+ 2 more

Network diversity

Asian Association Network	4
Latino Association Network	2
Middle East Association Network	2

Board age range

Overall range	50- 65
Between 50-60	8
Above 60	2

Board Analytics

Industry overlap (6)

Internet Software & Services	6
Financial services	2
Energy resource	4
Information Technology	3

+ 2 more

Board Announcement (2)

Joining soon
James Robert
Vice Chancellor
Effective from Aug, 2026

New to role
Evelyn Carter
CEO
Effective from 2025

Role changing
Robert Bill
Senior VP to President
Effective from 2025

UAT Results

Shipped May 2026.

Passed UAT on the first cycle, with additional data points requested on the way through. Those were a data issue rather than a design one, and it shipped fully on the second cycle.

What clients said

Usage has grown as clients migrate across, and feedback has **stayed positive.**

> "This is so much clearer than what I'm used to"
>
> Due Diligence Officer, major consultancy

> "The side panel is really a good addition. Now I can compare them right there."
>
> Researcher, banking services

> "I love the tag on Chairperson. I almost want that for all exec roles honestly"
>
> Researcher, executive search firm